

Union Budget 2025-26 allocates ₹260 billion for MeitY, a 48% increase

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) saw a 48% budget increase for FY26, rising to ₹260.26 billion. Key allocations include ₹20 billion for the IndiaAI Mission and an 83% rise in allocation for semiconductor development up to ₹70 billion. The PLI scheme for mobile manufacturing increased 45% to ₹88.85 billion, boosting exports, while IT hardware PLI grew 283% to ₹1.15 billion. However, concerns remain over ISM 2.0 clarity and component manufacturing PLI.



Budget 2025 reduces basic customs duties for components

The Union Budget 2025-26 introduced key tariff rationalisations set to impact India's electronics industry. Duties on interactive flat panel displays (IFPD) were increased, while duties on open cells were reduced to support production. Tariffs on critical minerals for EVs and mobile batteries

were fully exempted, lowering production costs. Additional duty cuts for data centre components, smart meters, and electronic goods aim to enhance local production, attract investment, and accelerate EV adoption.

PEOPLE (on the move)



Zoho CEO Sridhar Vembu steps down and takes R&D lead

Sridhar Vembu, Co-founder and CEO of Zoho, announced his decision to depart, transitioning to the role of Chief Scientist focused on R&D, especially in AI. Shailesh Kumar Davey will become the new CEO. Vembu's shift aims to

prioritise AI advancements and rural development, continuing Zoho's growth in software solutions.

AXISCADES appoints Nick Santhanam as ESAI Advisor

AXISCADES has named Nick Santhanam, former Senior Partner at McKinsey, an advisor for its Electronics, Semiconductors, and AI (ESAI) domain. With nearly three decades of leadership experience, the company looks to grow



under Santhanam's guidance and expertise in operational improvements and semiconductor industry leadership.

GlobalFoundries names Tim Breen CEO and Niels Anderskov COO



GlobalFoundries has appointed Tim Breen (left) as its new CEO, succeeding Thomas Caulfield, who transitioned to Board Chairman. Breen, previously the COO,

has led the company's global operations, strategy, and transformation efforts. Niels Anderskov (right), the current CBO, will assume the roles of COO and President. The company looks to grow in manufacturing and AI under their leadership.